

Preschool Bedtime Resistance Guide — Action Checklist

PRINT THIS PAGE AND KEEP IT SOMEWHERE VISIBLE

BUILD THE WIND-DOWN SEQUENCE

- ☐ **Give a 5-minute transition warning before bath so your preschooler can finish what they're doing without feeling blindsided by the change.:** Give a 5-minute transition warning before bath so your preschooler can finish what they're doing without feeling blindsided by the change.
- ☐ **Keep the bath calm with warm water and no rough play because the temperature drop afterward signals the brain that it's time to slow down.:** Keep the bath calm with warm water and no rough play because the temperature drop afterward signals the brain that it's time to slow down.
- ☐ **Read exactly two calm books in a low voice for about 10 minutes, choosing quiet stories about bedtime or gentle animal tales.:** Read exactly two calm books in a low voice for about 10 minutes, choosing quiet stories about bedtime or gentle animal tales.
- ☐ **Say the same lie-down phrase every night and leave the room immediately without lingering for extra goodnights or hugs.:** Say the same lie-down phrase every night and leave the room immediately without lingering for extra goodnights or hugs.

HOLD BOUNDARIES WITH SCRIPTS

- ☐ **When your child asks for one more book, say firmly:** 'We read two books. Tomorrow we can read two more.' — then stop talking.
- ☐ **When your child asks for a different song, respond with:** 'We sing the same song at bedtime. It's your song.' — then stop talking.
- ☐ **When your child asks for water at bedtime, say:** 'You had water with your bath. If you need more, you can have a sip in the morning.'
- ☐ **When your child says they need to potty at bedtime, take them once and say:** 'If you need to go in the night, call me.' — then stop talking.

REGULATE YOUR OWN RESPONSE

- ☐ **Notice the first sign of your own frustration during bedtime and name it silently so you can interrupt the escalation before it starts.:** Notice the first sign of your own frustration during bedtime and name it silently so you can interrupt the escalation before it starts.

 - ☐ **Use the 4-7-8 breathing technique yourself — breathe in for 4 counts, hold for 7, exhale for 8 — to stay physiologically calm.:** Use the 4-7-8 breathing technique yourself — breathe in for 4 counts, hold for 7, exhale for 8 — to stay physiologically calm.

 - ☐ **Accept that you cannot control your child's cooperation but you can change your own patterns, words, and responses to shift the dynamic.:** Accept that you cannot control your child's cooperation but you can change your own patterns, words, and responses to shift the dynamic.

 - ☐ **Focus on holding your calm, neutral tone during requests because your regulated state is what prevents the battle from escalating.:** Focus on holding your calm, neutral tone during requests because your regulated state is what prevents the battle from escalating.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.